VICTORY 2027

Treasure Chest : POETRY

# Haunted House

(Part-1)

Lecture 1 | ENGLISH

Nupur Ma'am



Physics Wallah

# TOPICS TO BE COVERED

1. Overview
2. Line by Line explanation
3. Word Meanings
4. MCQs
   ~~Important Questions and Answers~~



# WARM- UP

| | |
|---|---|
| quick | dare |
| damp | ache |
| crave | moist |
| challenge | persist |
| endure | exclude |
| gleam | swift |
| omit | dependable |
| discomfort | desire |
| reliable | glisten |
| transfer | exchange |



# TOPIC:

# INTRODUCTION



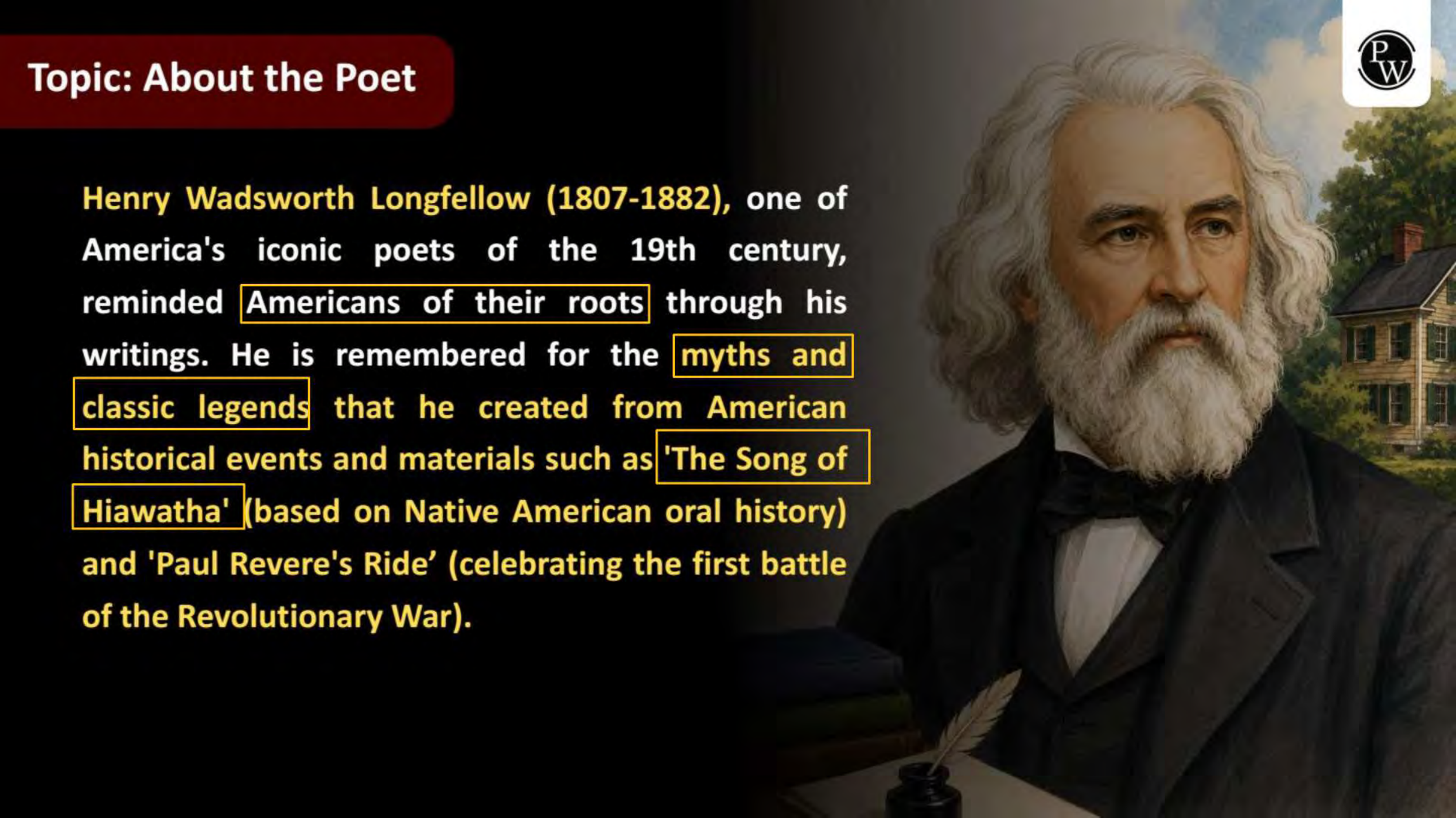
TOPIC : ABOUT THE POET

# HENRY WADSWORTH LONGFELLOW (1807-1882),

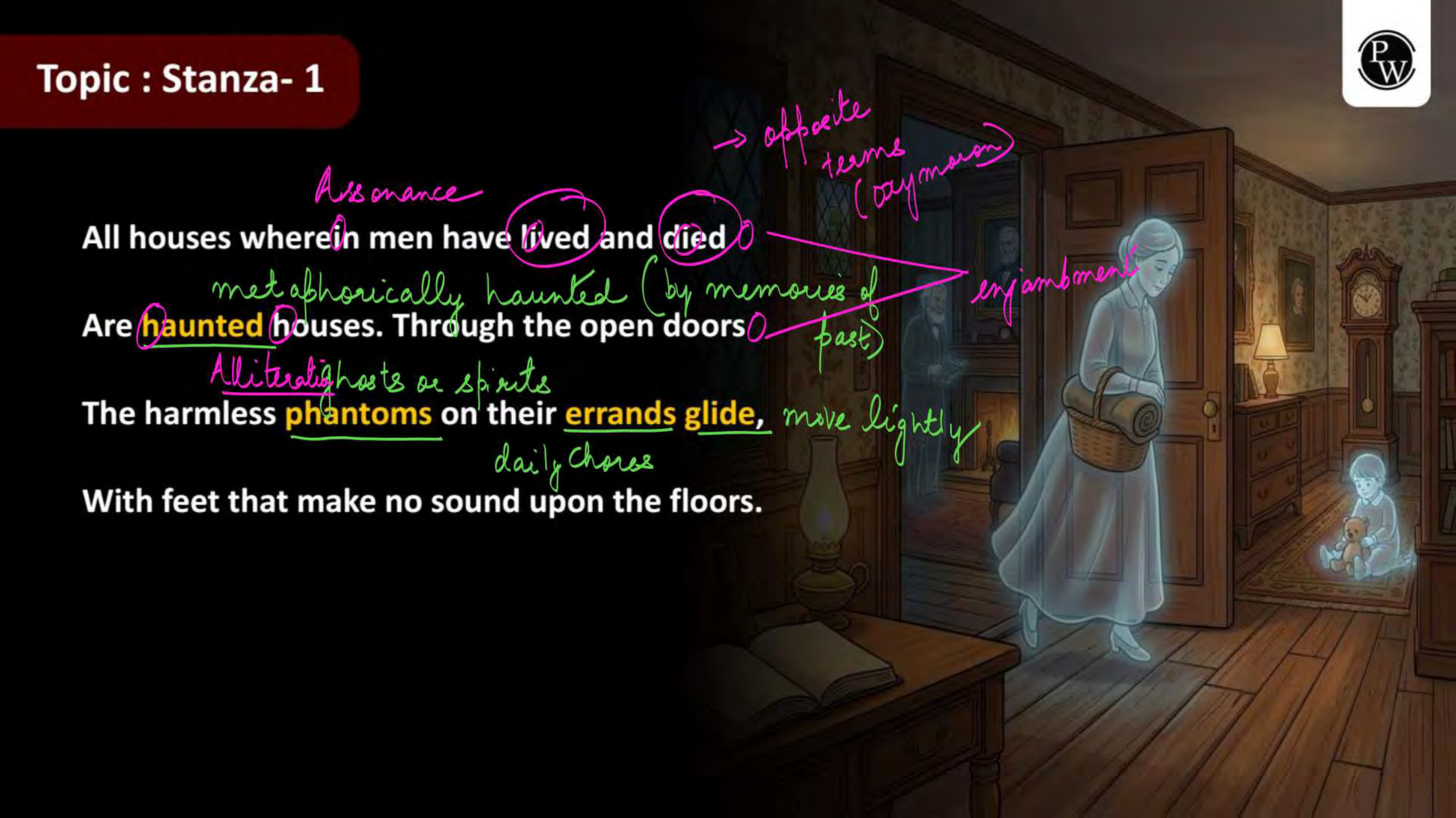


# Topic: About the Poet

Henry Wadsworth Longfellow (1807-1882), one of America's iconic poets of the 19th century, reminded Americans of their roots through his writings. He is remembered for the myths and classic legends that he created from American historical events and materials such as 'The Song of Hiawatha' (based on Native American oral history) and 'Paul Revere's Ride' (celebrating the first battle of the Revolutionary War).



## Topic : Stanza- 1



## Topic : Explanation

Ghosts ✗
Past Memories ✓

What are the features of these ghosts?

The first line sets the premise that every house in which people have lived and died is metaphorically haunted. The haunting represents the memories and the history of the people who once inhabited those houses.

He refers to the spirits as 'harmless phantoms', emphasizing that they are not terrifying but rather peaceful echoes of the past. These phantoms are silent, invisible presences who go about their daily tasks, much like the people who once lived there did.



# Topic: MCQ

Which part of the phantoms' bodies make no sound upon the floors?

1. Arms
2. Legs
3. Limbs
4. Feet

A) ~~From~~ 1

B) ~~Since~~ 2

C) ~~For~~ 3

D) ~~in~~ 4

## Topic : Stanza- 2

ghosts

We meet them at the door way, on the stair,

Visual imagery

Along the passages they come and go,

Corridors

Impalpable impressions on the air, – Resonance

something that cannot be touched (intangible)

A sense of something moving to and from.

here and there

's' → alliteration



# Topic: MCQ

What does "errands" imply in the context of the poem?

Chores = daily tasks

A) Chores done by the phantoms

B) Messages from the past

C) Journey undertaken by the spirits

D) Disturbances caused by the spirits

## Topic : Stanza- 3

There are more guests at table than the hosts

brightly lit

Invited; the illuminated hall

crowded harmless

Is thronged with quiet, inoffensive ghosts,

non offensive or objectionable

As silent as the pictures on the wall.

"Simile"

ghosts = pictures



# Topic: MCQ

The ghosts/phantoms in H.W Longfellow's Haunted Houses are described as:

A) harmless

B) mischievous ✓

C) malevolent evil ✓

D) vengeful Revengeful ✗

# Topic: MCQ

Which of the following options contains the same literary device as the given verse from the poem?

"As silent as the pictures on the wall"

Simile → comparision using 'as' and 'like'

A) Because I could not stop for death. He kindly stopped for me.

Personification

B) Where the mind is without fear, and the head is held high. → Alliteration

C) Soon, the sun's warmth makes them shed crystal shells, shattering and avalanching on the snow crust → Imagery, Alliteration

D) Some are like fields of sunlit corn. Simile

# Topic: MCQ

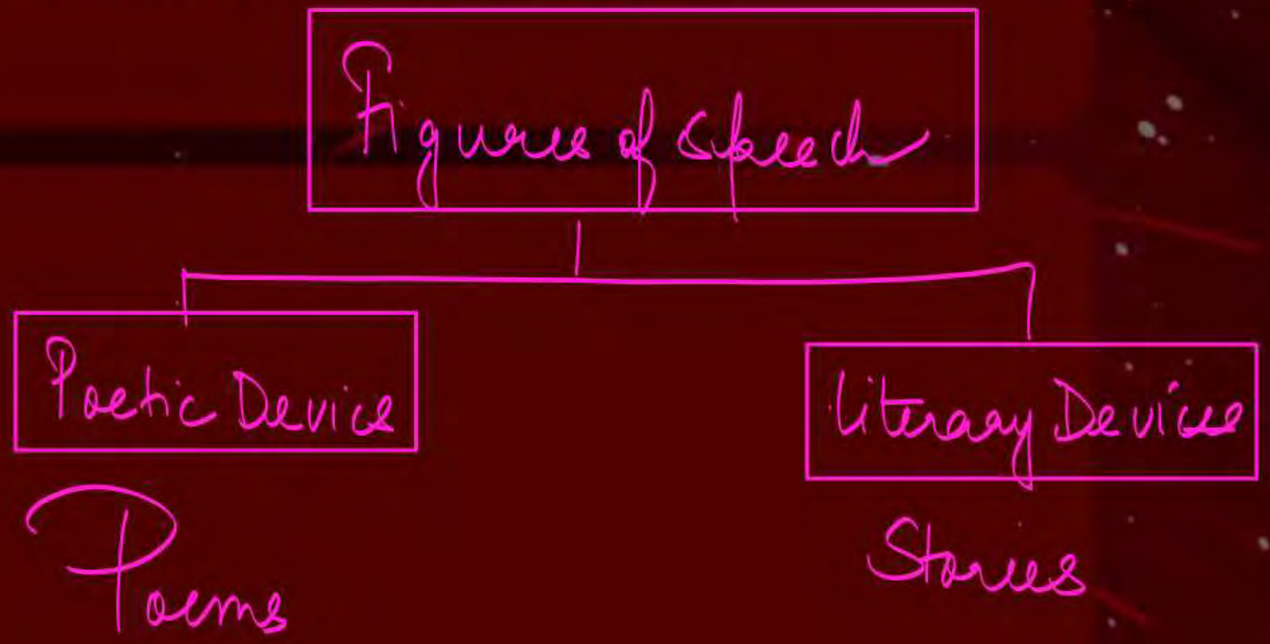
What is the nature of the "phantoms" that the poet refers to?

A) Malevolent and dangerous

B) Loud and noisy

C) Harmless and quiet

D) Visible and scary



## Topic : Stanza- 4

The stranger at my fireside cannot see

The forms I see, nor hear the sounds I hear;

He but perceives what is; while unto me

All that has been is visible and clear.



## Topic : Stanza- 5

documents

We have no title-deeds to house or lands;

Ghosts

Owners and occupants of earlier dates

From graves forgotten stretch their dusty hands,

hold in perpetuity (permanently)

And hold in mortmain still their old estates.

temporary

The speaker asserts the fleeting nature of material possessions. Despite people's claims to lands or houses, the spirits of the past continue to hold their estates symbolically, signifying the permanence of our spiritual legacies over material acquisitions.



# Topic: MCQ

According to the poem, to what do the people have no title-deeds?

1. House
2. Bungalows
3. Lands
4. Mansions

A) 1 and 3

B) 3 and 4

C) 1 and 2

D) 2 and 3

# Topic: MCQ

What is the meaning of the term "mortmain" used in the poem?

A) A large estate

B) A legal term meaning the condition of lands or tenements held in perpetuity

C) A type of contract

D) A type of ghost


Thank You!